

Virtually a breeze

Square, founded by Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey is a new mobile payment company which in essence allows making payments from any mobile device, securely

Kernel at risk

Microsoft warns of an unplugged security flaw in the 32-bit version of Windows allowing a hacker to install programs, tamper data, or create new accounts

IS YOUR E-MONEY SAFE?

With plastic money fast replacing cash transactions, we look at what could happen if your card falls into the wrong hands, both online and offline



Nash David and Siddharth Parwatay
nash.david@thinkdigit.com
siddharth.parwatay@thinkdigit.com

Undoubtedly, there is sufficient information out there to scare you from using your debit/credit card. We're not here to add to that. We're here to give you the much needed advice and information from the experts. India is considered one of the fastest growing markets in the world.

Average businesses prefer money on paper in the form of cheque or better still cash. However latest statistics show the trend is now changing. Both online credit card usage and real word plastic money is on the rise.

Last year, we carried a Digit Web awards special and in the category on tech shopping, eBay won our award. We spoke to Deepa Thomas, Senior Manager, Corporate Communication, eBay India to find out the trends they see in their visitors. According to her, "Although online

buying in India is still in a nascent stage, it is growing at a promising rate of 38 per cent according to figures by JuxtConsult. Today 8 million people transact online, with 38 million still 'window shopping'. 15 per cent of Indians are now transacting online. According to the Internet and Mobile Association of India, the e-commerce market in India is worth Rs. 9,800 crores." Window shopping online is an interesting subject. You don't even have to bother stepping out of your house. 380 lakh people visit shopping sites. This means they're interested in buying online, but either don't have the instruments to trade, or don't trust the web site enough. Why is that?

Tricks of the black trade

1. Spyware: Spyware is malicious software that gets downloaded to a computer without your knowledge when you visit a web site that is either malicious, or has been compromised. Spyware programs

run in the background and record information in real-time as it is being typed into a web site by a user. The software can store the information locally on the computer or forward it to a remote malicious computer.

2. Key logger applications: These are slightly more sophisticated spyware applications that can record a user's key strokes as they are being typed on the keyboard. They can capture sensitive information such as passwords or credit card numbers even when a web site and browser have set up a secure, encrypted channel of communications.

3. Proxy servers: Proxy servers are like filters through which all the internet connections in a cyber café are sent. Based on the various settings within the proxy server, data from unencrypted browsing sessions can be captured. This could lead to personal user information tracking that can be extracted from web sites and stored for later use.

4. Phishing: With this rapid growth in the online space, you have two ways of being duped. You'll either be scared to revealing critical personal information or enticed into greed. Phishing is a rising menace. Thomas adds, "Don't fall for those millions you've won in lottery from far off Sierra Leone. In fact, these days, in what is known as social engineering, scammers track your movements and are now using cellphones, emails as well as phone calls to connect with you and get you trapped."

Remember to check for the genuine signs of a true and verified web site. We came across one such spam email of a site that tricks you into revealing your details of Punjab National Bank. After the uninformed bait enters his/her vital information, the page directs all the information to an IP address based somewhere in Australia, before returning the home